Saint-Petersburg State University
Center for Sociological and Internet Studies

Representation of Russian larp community in Larp Census-2014 and social media

ALEKSANDRA TSAREVA
ALTSAREVA@GMAIL.COM

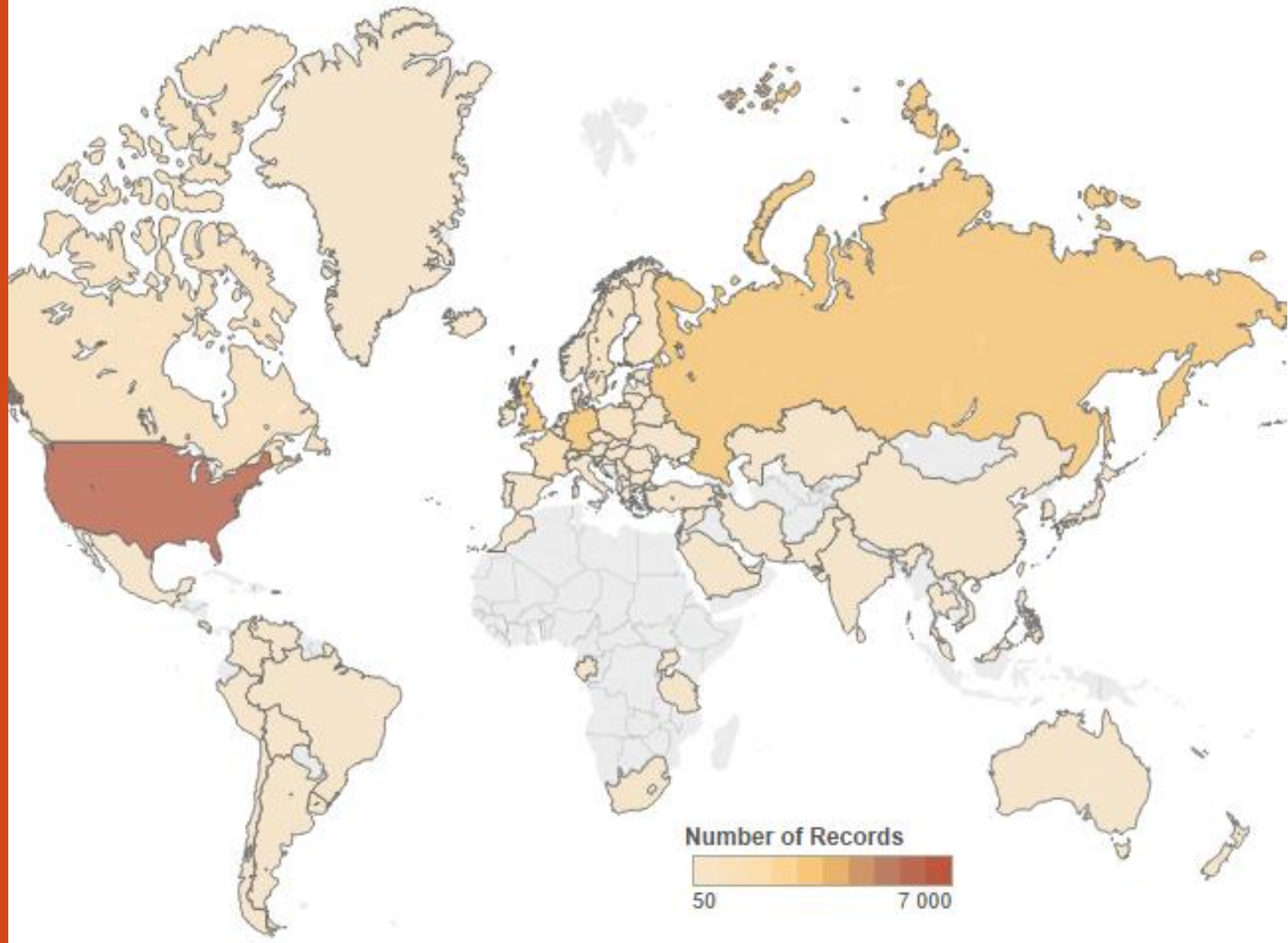
International Larp Census' 2014

Survey was organized by Aaron Vanek (USA) and Ryan Paddy (New Zealand)

larpcensus.org

More 30,000 responses from larpers around the world were collected.

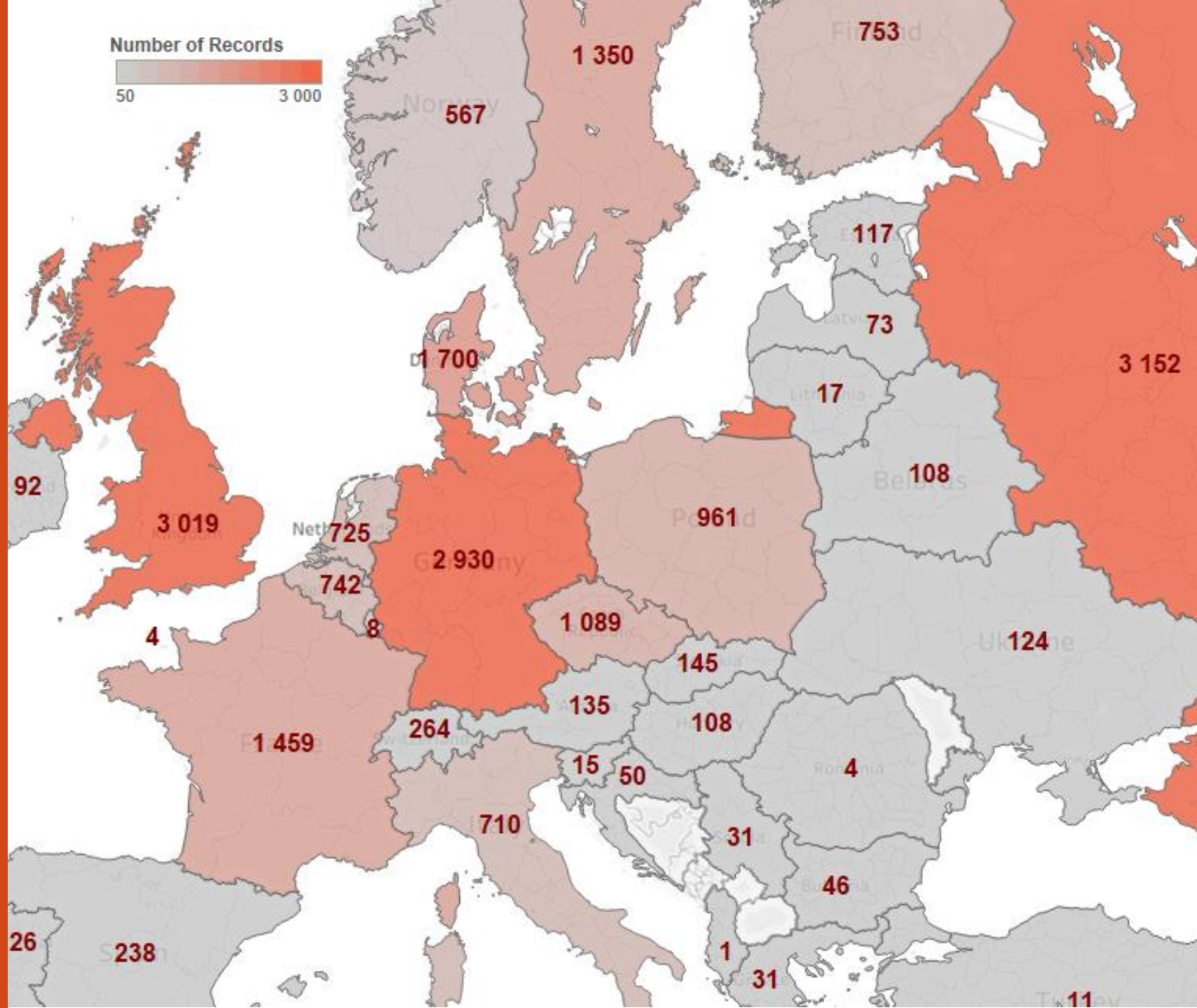
Survey was translated from English into 16 local language (Russian among them)



International Larp Census' 2014

For analysis original data were modified to exclude logically incorrect answers.

We will specifically talk about Russian larpers in comparison with two largest sets from European part of the survey: British and German ones.



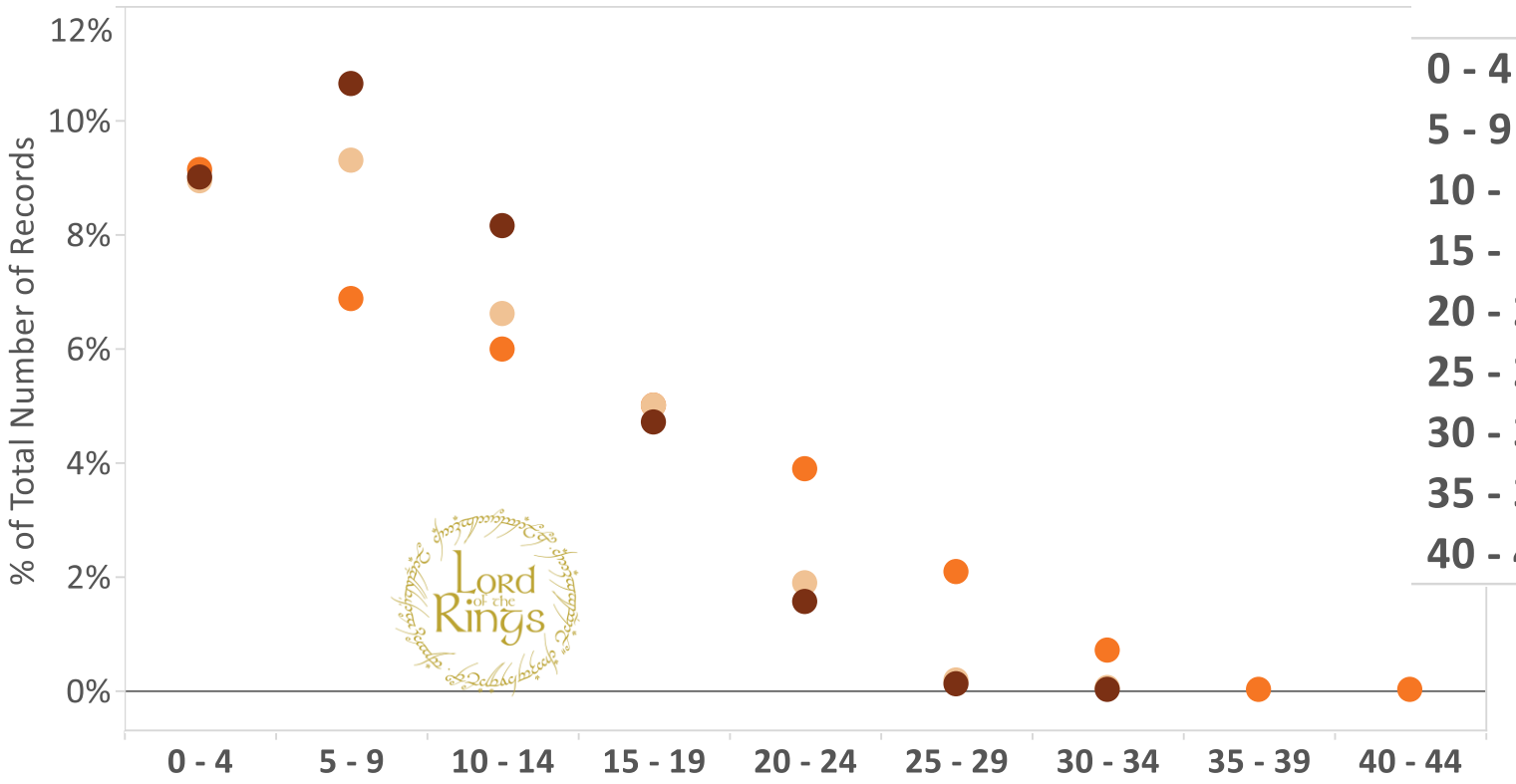
Demographics

		Germany	Russia	UK
Female	10 - 14	0,0%	0,3%	0,1%
	15 - 19	1,5%	3,7%	1,5%
	20 - 24	6,3%	10,4%	5,9%
	25 - 29	8,9%	14,1%	7,0%
	30 - 34	8,1%	6,9%	6,5%
	35 - 39	4,8%	3,3%	4,6%
	40 - 44	1,6%	1,1%	2,7%
	45 - 49	0,8%	0,6%	1,3%
	50 - 54	0,4%	0,1%	0,5%
	55 - 59		0,1%	0,4%
	60 - 64		0,0%	0,1%
	Prefer not to ans..	2,4%	3,7%	2,3%

		Germany	Russia	UK
Male	10 - 14	0,1%	0,1%	0,1%
	15 - 19	2,5%	4,2%	2,6%
	20 - 24	10,0%	12,1%	7,5%
	25 - 29	13,2%	16,1%	11,7%
	30 - 34	13,7%	9,8%	11,6%
	35 - 39	11,9%	4,9%	11,4%
	40 - 44	5,6%	1,6%	8,5%
	45 - 49	1,6%	0,4%	4,2%
	50 - 54	0,6%	0,2%	1,8%
	55 - 59	0,3%	0,1%	0,5%
	60 - 64	0,1%		0,3%
	65 - 69		0,0%	0,1%
	Prefer not to ans..	4,1%	4,2%	3,4%

	Germany	Russia	UK
Non-binary / Prefer not to answer	1,50%	1,94%	3,48%

“Role-playing” demographics



	Russia	Germany	UK
0 - 4	8,99%	8,93%	9,14%
5 - 9	10,63%	9,30%	6,89%
10 - 14	8,14%	6,61%	6,00%
15 - 19	4,72%	5,01%	5,01%
20 - 24	1,56%	1,90%	3,91%
25 - 29	0,11%	0,18%	2,09%
30 - 34	0,02%	0,07%	0,72%
35 - 39			0,03%
40 - 44			0,03%

Weak correlation with age:

Spearman Corr. < 0.3

Question: “How many years have you been participating in live action role playing?”

What is specific of Russian larps?

- Mostly stand-alone events, A few campaign larps
  - 82,2% and 93,8% German and British larpers and only 48,6% among Russian ones visited serial events. 89,6% Russian participants have gone to in the last 12 months to stand-alone ones.
- Russian larpers is more likely to play larp in their home town (55,3%)
- The most popular settings is fantasy or mythology. But in Russia there are more people who visited SyFy, historical and modern based larps.
  - It can be very inaccurate (talk about it later)
- Russian are big fans of modelling: 35,9% survey Russian participants in the last 12 month visited larps where result of physical combat were determined by representational mechanics such as rock/paper/scissors, cards or comparing numbers (4,8% German and 15,1% British)
- Russian larps are more likely to be based on books

What is specific of Russian larps?

- Russian larps often take place in wild public land or private residence
  - 83,8% of Russian paricipants went to larp in wild areas, 28,9% — private houses.
  - German and British larpers are more likely to play in private farmlands
- We can suppose a lot of big larp (1000+): a half German and British attended it in the last year. In Russia we have a few (and still 22,4% visited it)
- Russian larp organizers more often work alone, without team. Only 1,4% from Russia worked in creating larp process within 100+ team.
- Most important things for Russian organizers: artistic expression, entertainment and influencing society (in this order). German and British were interested in artistic expression much less

What is specific of Russian larps?

Disagree or strongly disagree with

- “I prefer larps with few or no rules or game mechanics.” (German people mostly agree)
- “I've learned a lot from the ideas of larpers in other countries.” (Unlike both European sets)

Also

- Much more Russian people mentioned that enjoyed larps to give them a new perspective on the real world.
- Less Russians participate in games to spend time with friends.
- And less enjoy play a leader roles!

Little observations for inaccurate statistic

- Only 30,1% Russian larpers reported that participated in a larp in last month.
  - Germany: 43,1%
  - United Kingdom: 47,4%

Information about larp census among Russian larps was in October (and later).

And we mostly play at summer (called “role season”).

- Extremely more participants for formal discussion of larp — 47,0%
  - Germany: 10,3%
  - United Kingdom: 9,3%

Need more data!

Largest Larp Public

Vkontakte is the biggest social media in Russia (especially for youth).

Just a few larp events in Russia don’t have vkontakte public.

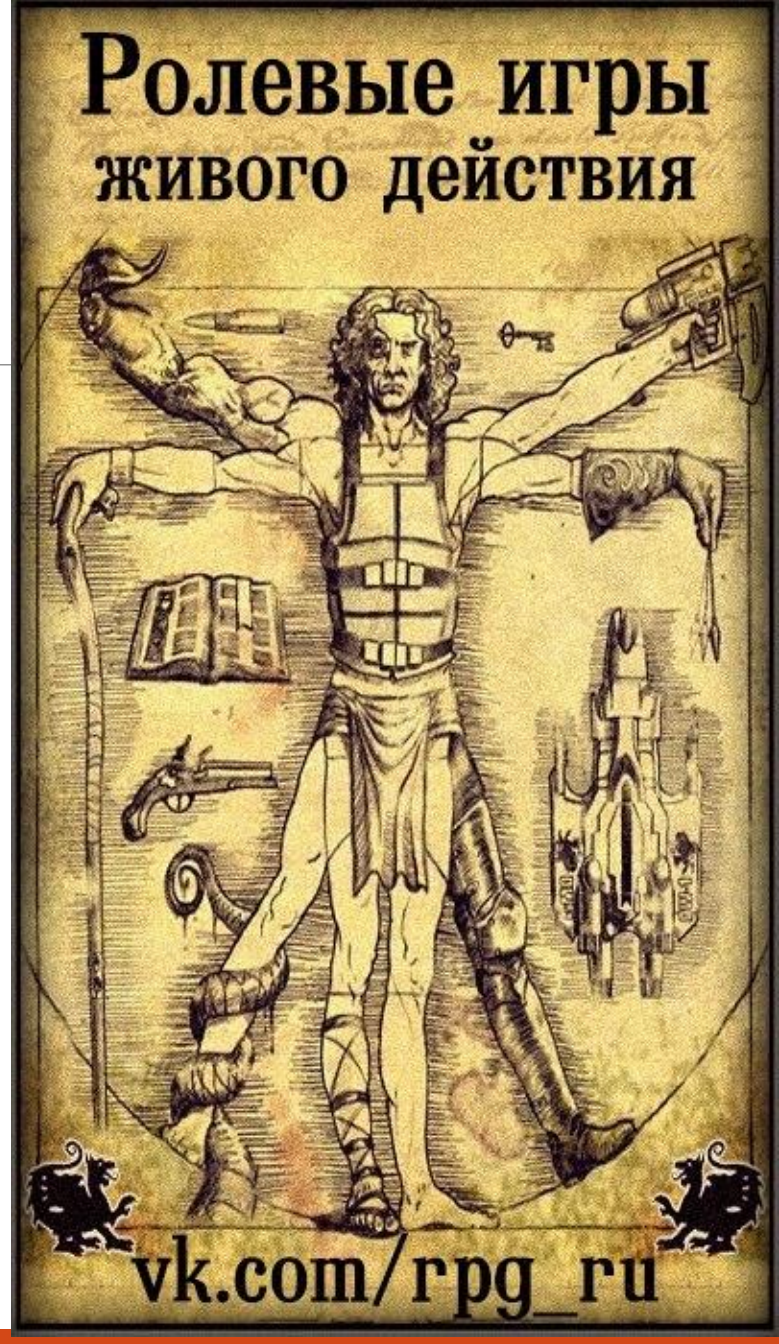
Data for December, 2016

22 285 subscribers:

some botes,

some people who are interested in larp

and larpers themselves

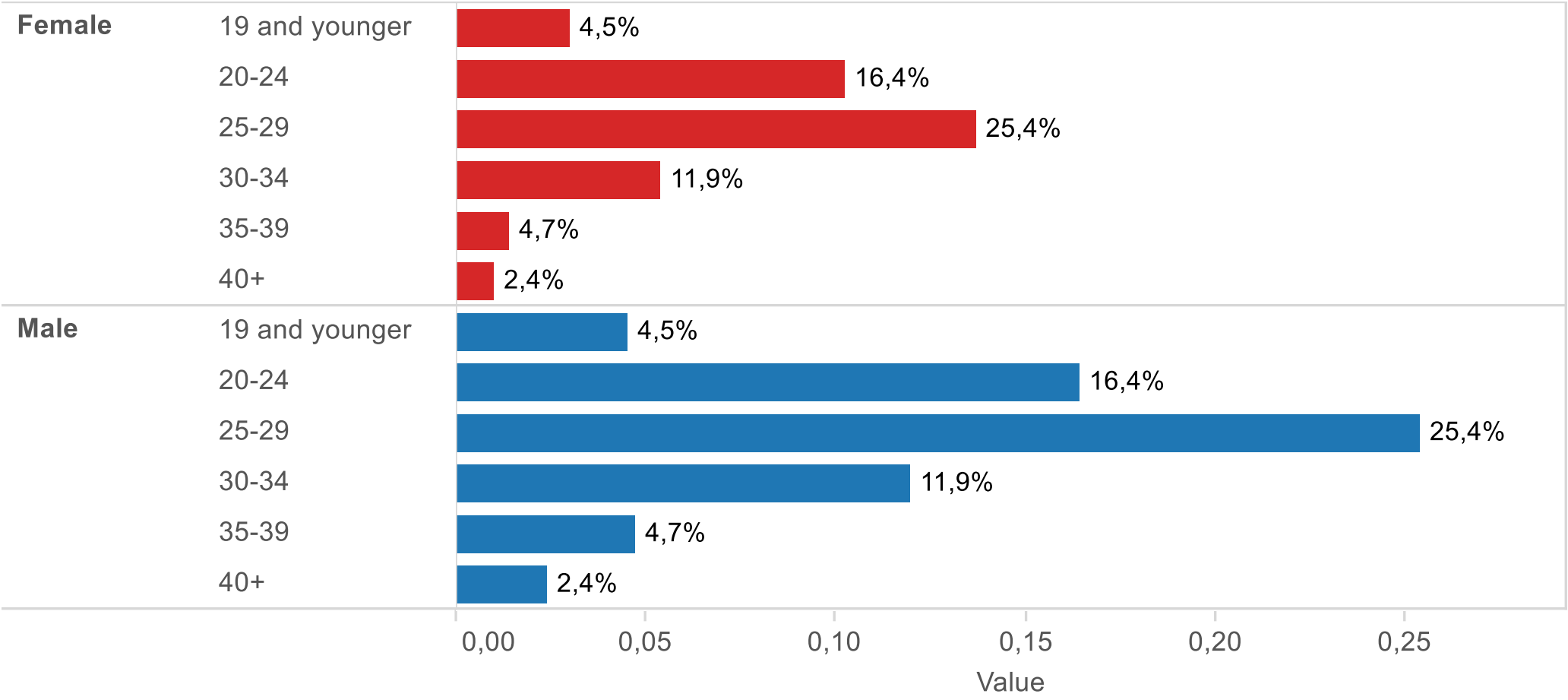


Top-10 cities

Moscow	22,7%
Saint-Petersburg	16,3%
Novosibirsk	2,9%
Ekaterinburg	2,3%
Nizhny Novgorod	2,2%
Krasnoyarsk	1,8%
Kazan	1,6%
Voronezh	1,5%
Rostov-on-Don	1,3%
Krasnodar	1,2%

Number of Records
1 000
2 000
3 000
4 000
5 000
6 000

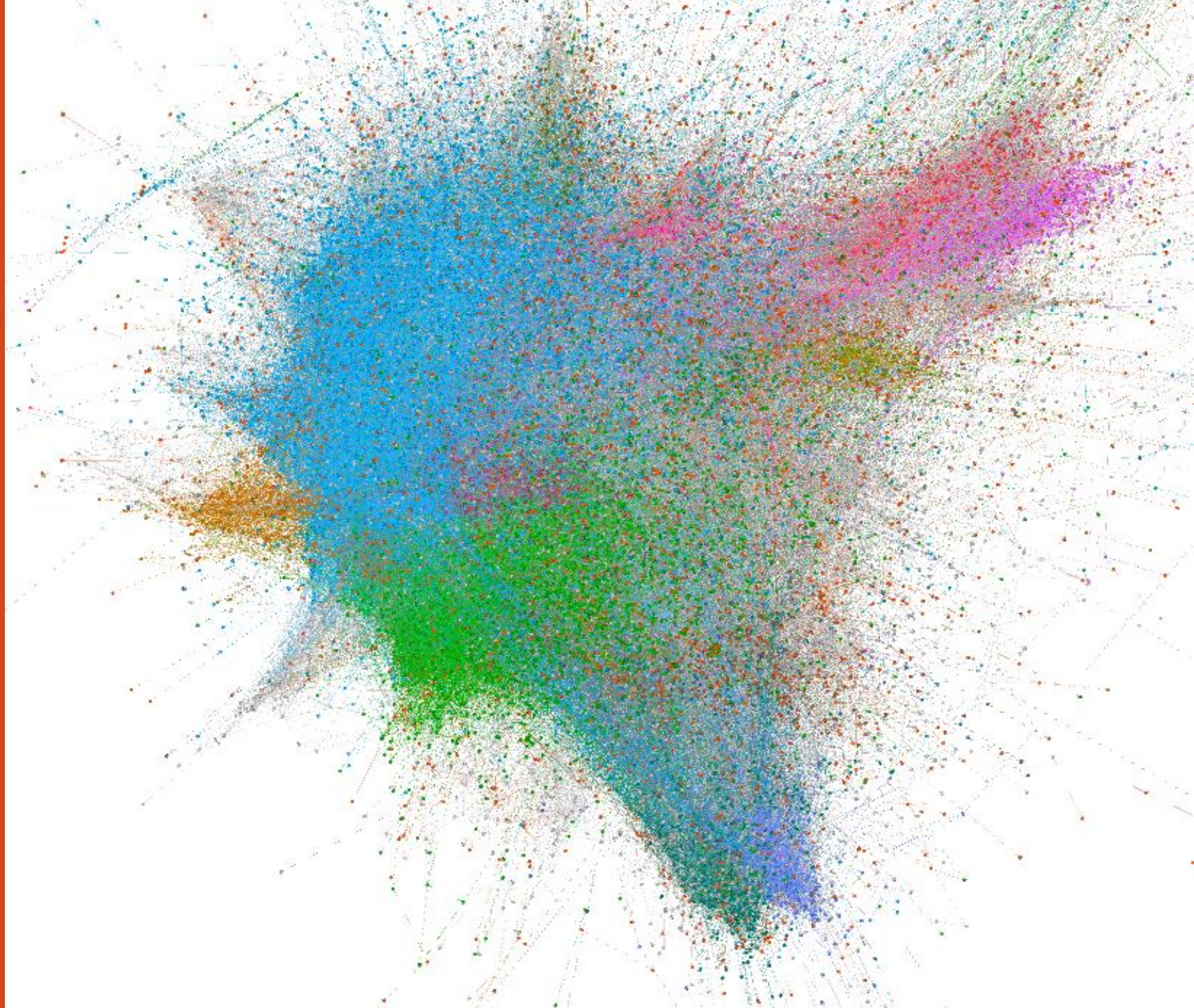
Demographics for social media



Friends graph

Clusters created by Force Atlas algorithm

- no data
- Moscow
- Saint-Petersburg
- Kiev
- Novosibirsk
- Ekaterinburg
- Nizhny Novgorod
- Harkov
- Krasnoyarsk
- Kazan
- Voronezh
- Minsk
- Rostov-on-Don
- Krasnodar
- Samara
- Chelyabinsk
- others



More data?

KOGDA-IGRA.RU

The largest Russian larp calendar

More 300 larps during 2016

Average number of players is about 90

MORE INFORMATION IN SOCIAL MEDIA

Thank your for attention!